

Starting in 2019, the City of Chicago required large buildings to report energy use and display their rating placard publicly. The team used energy benchmarking data from 2015-2023 to examine whether these policies are working as intended.

From 2018 to 2023, Chicago's building energy use changed substantially, but it was difficult to separate the effects of the placard policy from the disruptions caused by COVID-19 and other unrelated trends. To better distinguish potential policy impacts from macro shocks, we incorporated data from three comparison cities and conducted difference-in-differences analyses. When comparing Chicago with comparison cities we see similar declines across all cities, but with varying magnitudes (Figure 1).

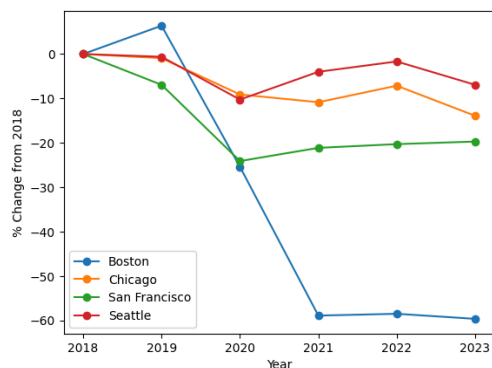


Figure 1: Site EUI Change Since 2018

Large buildings are required to report energy use, however from 2018-2023 we see over 3000 instances of non reporting. Using reporting status, we examined compliance patterns from 2018–2023 (Figure 2). Overall, the share of buildings marked as “Submitted” stays about the same across all years, suggesting that reporting wcompliance has not improved over time. The team also added to the existing Streamlit dashboard with a new page for building compliance, allowing users explore compliance rates using various filters and groupings.

Compliance distribution by category and year

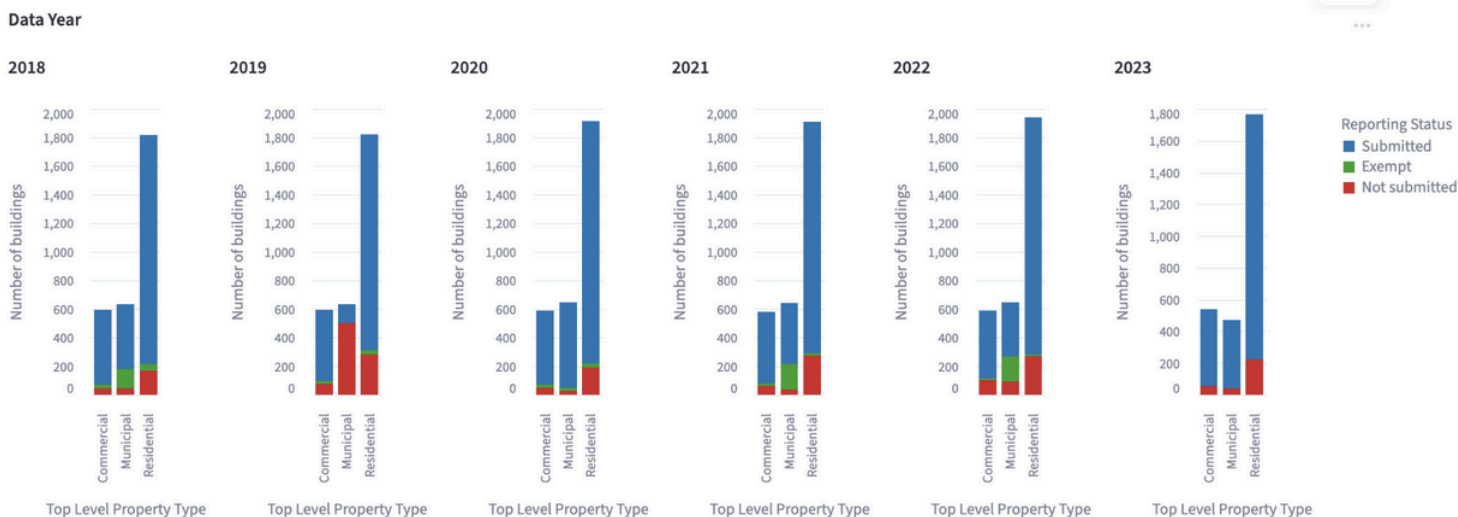


Figure 2: Compliance distribution by Top Level Property Types and Year